

EPIC: LATE CHARGES

Glossary:

Late Charges: CHRISTUS Ministries and/or departments may add late charges after the final account bills. These charges are often the result of coding changes, charges added by other departments, or late payment fees.

Types of Late Charges:

- Late Replacement (TOB XX7): Send new claim including late charges
- Late Claim (TOB XX5): Send claim with only late charges
- Write-Off: Write Off Charges
- **Late Addition: Add Charges to Pending Initial Claim**

Type of Bill (TOB): Is required in all claims and is a four-digit numeric code that gives specific pieces of information after a leading 0.

- The first digit identifies the type of facility.
- The second classifies the type of care.
- The third indicates the sequence of this bill in this episode of care, it is referred to as “frequency” code.

The next are the types of bills:

- 11X: Hospital Inpatient (Including Medicare Part A)
- 12x: Hospital Inpatient (Medicare Part B Only)
- 13x: Hospital Outpatient
- 14x: Hospital-Laboratory Services Provided to Non-Patients
- 18x: Hospital-Swing Beds
- 85x: Critical Access Hospital
- 21X: Skilled Nursing (SNF)-Inpatient (Including Medicare Part A)
- 71X: Clinical-Rural Health (RHC)
- 72x: Clinical-Hospital Based or Independent Renal Dialysis Center (ESRD)

And the next are the different types of claims:

- XX1: New Day
- XX7: Corrected
- XX8: Void/Cancel

The following steps will guide you in EPIC to process **Late Charges**:

- Before processing late charge, it is necessary to confirm if a payment from insurance has been made. This can be seen in the **Hosp Tx Inquiry** tab.

In here there is a section called **payments & refunds** where we can find 3 different statuses of payments:

1. **No payments**: In this case the insurance hasn't made any payment, so the account must be deferred.
2. **Self-pay** (Payment done by the patient without involvement by any insurance): In order to process the late charge, a payment made by the insurance is needed. This case needs to be deferred.
3. Insurance payment: When a payment is made by an insurance company, we will be able to process the late charge.

- **Defer account:**

- Deferring an account is to send the account to a holding queue until a determined amount of time expecting updates.
- To defer an account the process is:
 1. Locate **Liability Buckets** tab and click on the button **Defer**. It will pop-up a window asking for the next information:
 - **Reason:** here we will search on the magnifying icon the reason why we are deferring the account (in most of the cases we put "pending insurance process").
 - **Until time:** Will be selecting the amount of time (1, 7, 14, 30 days) the account will be deferred (The standard is 14 days, but the amount can vary depending on the situation).
 - **Comment:** In this section we are complementing the reason for deferring the account.
 2. Once we have fulfilled the information, we click on the **"Defer"** button to continue with this one. If we don't want to continue with this process just click **"Don't defer"**.

- Identify the **Patient status:**

- Every patient has a different reason to use our services. In the system we classify their cases as patient status, and this determines the way that late charges will be worked.
- The patient status is determined by the **Type of bill (TOB)**. This can be in the **Liability Buckets** tab in the section **Insurance**.

- **Processing the late charge:**

- There are two different ways to classify the way the late charge will be worked; we can identify this with the account class that is based on the **TOB**. This will be:
 - **13X: Outpatient (OP):** This has a threshold of \$1,000
 - **11X-Inpatient (IP):** This has a threshold on \$10,000
 - Each threshold determines the way the late charge will be worked. Once we identify all the past information, we are ready to start the late charge process.
1. The correct way to start processing late charges, after we make sure that it has an insurance payment and identify if it is OP or IP. Go to the **Liability Buckets** tab, on the Prebilled section, then click on the “status”. Click “Transactions” to see the amount of the late charges, also known as **Balance**.
 2. To process the late charge first we click on the “**Account Activities**” tab, and then search in the Account Activity bucket the “**Process Late Charges [932]**”
 3. Depending on the balance of the late charge and the TOB create the note to document the actions done in this account. For example:
 - **If it’s an outpatient (OP) and the late charge balance is greater than \$1,000.00 or -\$1,000.00:** OP Late charge filled above threshold
 - **If it’s an outpatient (OP) and the late charge balance is lower than \$1,000.00 or -\$1,000.00:** OP Late charge filled below threshold
 - **If it’s an inpatient (IP) and the late charge balance is greater than \$10,000.00 or -\$10,000.00:** IP Late charge filled above threshold
 - **If it’s an inpatient (IP) and the late charge balance is greater than \$10,000.00 or -\$10,000.00:** IP Late charge filled above threshold
 - **If the balance is equal to 0 (Zero),** no matter if it is OP or IP, the comment will be: Zero Late Charge, No change
 4. Each insurance asks for a preferred way to receive their late charge claims; For this the options “Late replacement”, “Late claim”, “Write-off” and “Late addition” will be able to process the late charge.
After documenting the action, in the **Account Activity Bucket** the penultimate section called Process late charges it will be available the next options:
 - **Late replacement:** Select this option when the balance is above the threshold. This is the most common option that insurance request to use except for Medicaid TX or AR.
 - **Late claim:** Use this option when the account has the coverage of Medicaid TX or AR.
 - **Write-Off:** This option is used in 2 cases:
 - When the balance is below threshold. No matter the patient status or insurance.

- When the balance in the late charge is equal 0 (Zero).

- **Late Addition:**

5. Finally, after a double check in the account and in our documentation, the late charge is ready to be processed. In the last section on the Account Activity bucket, the Account WQ Action gives us the option of **“Complete”**. We select it and then **“Accept”**

We will notice that the account is no longer on the “Active WQ”.

Undo All Billing Cases

- The Undo Billing activity allows you to move the liability backwards to the previous payer bucket. Undo Billing is needed in order to update coverage/filing order of buckets if a bucket has been billed already.
- There are 2 cases when the undo billing is needed:
 - **Undo billing due to no previous charges billed to payer:** These cases are identified because in the **“Liability buckets”** tab, in the section called insurance only one claim can be visible. And this claim, instead of having an invoice number it will appear in blank, showing that there is a pending claim and instead of having the **“Last Clm”** (or claim date) it will appear blank.
 - **Undo billing due to “Error Claim”:** In the **“Liability buckets”** tab, in the section called insurance, a claim with instead of invoice number it will appear **“Error Claim”** and in the **“Last Clm”** it will appear blank.
- **Processing Undo All Billing:**
 1. After identifying the type of undo billing that will be processed open the **“Account activity”** tab and search for **“Undo All Billing [933]”**
 2. Once we select **“Undo All Billing”** we document our activity depending on the case we are working on. For example:
 - Undo all billing to process charges of \$X.XX due to no previous charges billed to payer.
 - Undo all billing to process charges of \$X.XX due to Error Claim
 3. To finish the process, select **“Complete”** and then **“Accept”**